

StepIn: Accelerating Integration Through Daily News

Understanding your new home — from day one.

The Problem: Integration Takes Too Long

302,199 immigrants arrive in the Netherlands annually. Yet: - **2+ years** wait before formal integration begins - **73%** of status holders have unknown education level - **Too many** lack sustainable employment (*State Secretary Nobel, 2026*) - Municipalities spend **€2,500–4,000** per status holder on interpretation annually

The 2026 interim evaluation confirms: *waiting times are too long and combining work with language lessons remains difficult.*

The Insight: Language = Civic Participation

Research shows: - **Higher language proficiency directly increases civic engagement** among immigrants (*Boyd, 2012*) - Host-country news consumption improves political knowledge and language skills (*Dalisay, 2012*) - Native-language media helps immigrants navigate host society (*Zhou & Cai, 2002*) - **Balanced use of both leads to better outcomes** (*Reis, 2010; Mao, 2015*)

The gap: No tool exists that combines both simultaneously.

Our Solution: StepIn

A dual-mode news platform available **24/7, immediately, at zero cost to municipalities.**

Mode	What It Does
Native Language	Dutch news translated into 9 languages (Turkish, Arabic, Polish, Ukrainian, French, Farsi, Italian, Romanian, Bulgarian)
Dutch Learner	Simplified Dutch (A2/B1/B2) + vocabulary translations

User flow: Access → Understanding → Language Acquisition → Integration

How It Aligns with Your Priorities

Government Priority	How StepIn Supports
<i>Actieagenda Integratie</i> (2025)	Language and employment as cornerstones — StepIn provides daily language exposure from day one
2026 evaluation findings	Addresses <i>waiting times</i> , <i>work-language combination</i> , and <i>sustainable employment</i>
Performance-based funding (2026)	10% of municipal funding tied to successful completion — StepIn accelerates outcomes
Early activation in AZCs	StepIn works from day of arrival, even before formal integration

The Business Case: Cost Savings

Cost Category	Current	With StepIn	Savings
Interpretation services	€2,500–4,000/year	€1,750–2,800/year	€750–1,200 per status holder
Language exposure	€500–3,000 (courses)	€11–18/year (supplement)	90–95% for marginal exposure

Annual savings for 30,000 status holders: €22.5–36 million.

StepIn supplements, not replaces, formal language courses — but reduces time to completion and interpretation costs.

Pilot Opportunity: What We're Asking

Zero upfront cost. 3-month trial. Measurable outcomes.

We Provide	You Provide
Daily news in 9 languages	Access to status holders
Simplified Dutch + translations	Feedback loop
Usage analytics	Pilot evaluation
Integration with existing programs	One champion to coordinate

Success metrics: - 30%+ daily active users - 20–30% reduction in interpretation requests (based on Rotterdam pilot) - Positive user feedback

Technical Overview

Component	Details
Platform	Telegram (no app install)
Languages	9 + Dutch learner
Articles	1–10 per day (user-selected)
Content	NOS Binnenland (trusted source)
Cost to municipality	€0 for pilot

Contact

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Ready to pilot? Let's discuss how StepIn can support your integration targets.

StepIn is an independent initiative supported by research from the University of Amsterdam and aligned with the Civic Integration Act evaluation recommendations.